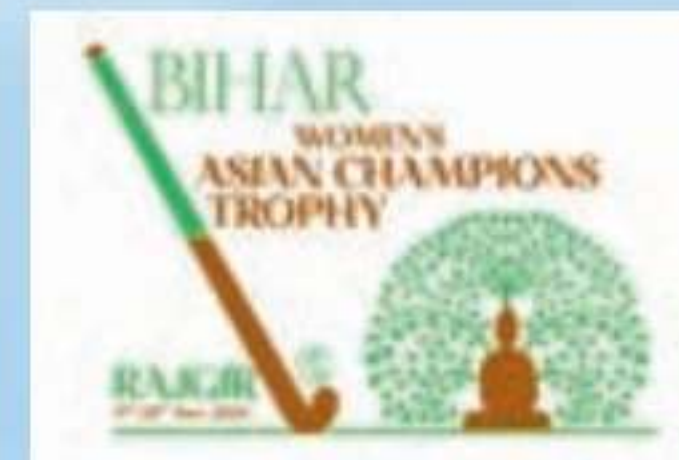


BIHAR'S SPORTS LEGACY AND ITS MISSION OLYMPICS

Bihar, a land historically renowned for its contributions to science, education, medicine, statecraft, and spirituality, holds an equally significant yet lesser-known place in India's sports history. Few are aware that the torch of the Olympic movement in India was first lit in Patna, Bihar, by the visionary JRD Tata and Moinul Haque. A key piece of evidence lies in the 1943 draft proceedings of the executive body of the Indian Olympic Association (IOA), which reveal that the IOA's first office was established and operated in Patna, making the city a pioneering centre for sports administration in the country.

Building on this legacy, the Government of Bihar, under the visionary leadership of the honourable Chief Minister Nitish Kumar, has set out to reclaim the state's historic prominence in sports. With a clear roadmap, the government aims to unlock the untapped potential of Bihar's youth and transform sports into a mass

movement across the state. In 2022, the Sports Development Authority of Bihar (SDAB), now known as the Bihar State Sports Authority (BSSA), was entrusted with the monumental task of identifying and nurturing talent in priority sports disciplines.



Recognising that existing sports development models across various Indian states may not be universally applicable, Bihar sought a distinct approach. The State's Sports Policy was

crafted with careful consideration of the anthropometric characteristics, gene pool, and inherent talents of Bihar's youth, aiming to create a tailored plan suited to the state's unique context. Although certain sports and regions within Bihar have already been identified as having significant potential, the government acknowledges the need for expertise and guidance from seasoned professionals in the field of sports to help craft a roadmap for achieving

